

Bomb Threat Response

Policy Number	POL-EM-056	Owner / Department	Security / Emergency Management
Effective Date	2023-10-15	Version	2.2
Last Revised	2026-02-26	Next Review	2028-02-26
Approved By	Emergency Management Committee	Applies To	All staff who may receive a threat (operators, unit clerks, front-line staff); coordinated by Security

1. Purpose

To ensure a calm, information-gathering response to a bomb threat or suspicious package that protects occupants, preserves evidence, and defers tactical decisions to law enforcement, consistent with FBI/DHS (CISA) bomb-threat guidance and The Joint Commission Emergency Management standards.

2. Scope

Applies to any bomb threat received by phone, in writing, by email, or verbally, and to the discovery of a suspicious or unattended package anywhere on the campus. The person who receives a telephoned threat keeps the caller on the line and records details; they do not decide whether to evacuate.

3. Definitions

- **Bomb threat** — a communicated threat, with or without a device, to detonate an explosive to cause harm or disruption.
- **Suspicious package** — an unattended or unusual item with characteristics suggesting a possible explosive device.
- **Bomb-threat checklist** — the standardized form used to capture caller details, exact wording, and background sounds in real time.

4. Procedure — Telephoned Threat

IMPORTANT — Stay calm, keep the caller talking, and write down every detail. Do not hang up even after the caller does. If a suspicious item is found, do not touch, move, or open it and do not use radios or cell phones near it — they can trigger a device. Call 911 and Security immediately, then follow law-enforcement direction on search and evacuation.

1. Keep the caller on the line; do not hang up. Signal a coworker to call 911 and Security.
2. Complete the bomb-threat checklist: exact wording, stated location and time of detonation, caller voice/accent, and background noises.
3. After the call, preserve the caller-ID display and your notes; do not erase anything.

4. For a suspicious package, do not touch or move it, clear and cordon the area, and avoid radio/cell transmissions nearby.
5. Security and law enforcement direct any search (staff know their own areas best) and any evacuation or shelter decision.
6. File an event report per POL-RM-013 once the scene is released.

5. Severity & Reporting

A bomb threat is at least a **SEV-2** event under POL-RM-013 and is escalated to **SEV-1** when a device or credible suspicious package is found, an evacuation is ordered, or anyone is injured. Notify law enforcement (911) and Security **immediately**; notify the Administrator-on-Call and Safety Officer within 1 hour for a SEV-1, within 4 hours otherwise, and activate HICS if the facility is searched or evacuated. All threats, including those deemed non-credible, are documented and reported within 24 hours.

6. Documentation Requirements

- Completed bomb-threat checklist with exact wording and time of the threat.
- Caller-ID / source information and how the threat was received.
- Areas searched or evacuated; whether a device or package was found and its disposition.
- Law-enforcement notification and response; HICS activation and all notifications.

7. References

- DHS/CISA, Bomb Threat Guidance and DHS Bomb Threat Checklist; FBI bomb-threat resources.
- The Joint Commission, Emergency Management (EM) standards.
- CMS Emergency Preparedness Rule, 42 CFR 482.15.
- Related: POL-RM-013 (severity & reporting), POL-EM-052 (active shooter), POL-EM-053 (HICS / Code Triage).